HOW TO USE THE BOOK

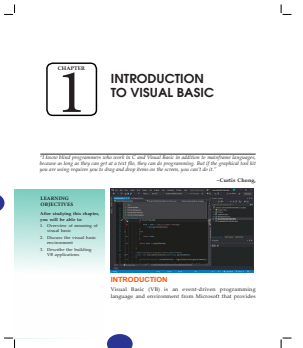
This book has been divided into many chapters. Chapter gives the motivation for this book and the use of templates. The text is presented in the simplest language. Each paragraph has been arranged under a suitable heading for easy retention of concept. Keywords are the words that academics use to reveal the internal structure of an author's reasoning. Review questions at the end of each chapter ask students to review or explain the concepts. References provides the reader an additional source through which he/she can obtain more information regarding the topic.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

See what you are going to cover and what you should already know at the start of each chapter

ABOUT THIS CHAPTER

An introduction is a beginning of section which states the purpose and goals of the topics which are discussed in the chapter. It also starts the topics in brief.



CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION TO VISUAL BASIC

"I know blind programmers who work in C and Visual Basic in addition to mainframe languages, because as long as they can get at a text file, they can do programming. But if the graphical tool kit you are using requires you to drag and drop items on the screen, you can't do it."

–Curtis Chong.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

After studying this chapter, you will be able to

1. Overview of meaning of visual basic
2. Discuss the visual basic programming
3. Describe the building VB applications

INTRODUCTION

Visual Basic (VB) is an event-driven programming language and environment from Microsoft that provides

enhancements, including the striking ability of creating web based applications. The extended support for Visual Basic 6.0 was ceased in the month of March in 2008. The basic parts of development environment of Visual Basic 6, however, still run in all the 32-bit Microsoft windows, including Windows 8.1.

After the cessation of mainstream and extended support for Visual Basic 6.0 caused a number of programs to show concern. The community members then created a lobby of users and a petition was signed by them. The basic aim of this petition was to ensure that the product remains alive. However, the petition did not attain its aim effectively.

1.1.2 The Importance of Visual Basic Programming Language

Visual Basic is regarded as the third generation event-drivon programming language. It was released in 1987. Being the first visual development tool from Microsoft, it is considered as one of the most powerful programming languages. As compared to other computer programming languages, such as, C, C++, it is easy to learn and understand, provided that one has determination and dedication to do so.

Visual basic programming language allows programmers to create software interface and codes in an easy to use graphical environment. VB is the combination of different components that are used on forms having specific attributes and actions with the help of those components. On the one hand it allows programmers to develop seldom based applications rapidly; on the other hand, it helps greatly in accessing data bases, using ADO while letting the programmers use ActiveX controls and various objects. While it is intended more to develop applications, it is also useful for games development for particular or limited purposes, unlike C++ that is more suitable for developing games.

As compared to other languages, Visual basic may be slower though, yet it is flexible and it can be rightly said that things that are difficult in other languages are comparatively easier in visual basic programming language. It may also be said that, since it is one of the most popular programming languages, lots of related books and material and other resources are available and can be accessed for developing programming skills at visual basic programming language conveniently.

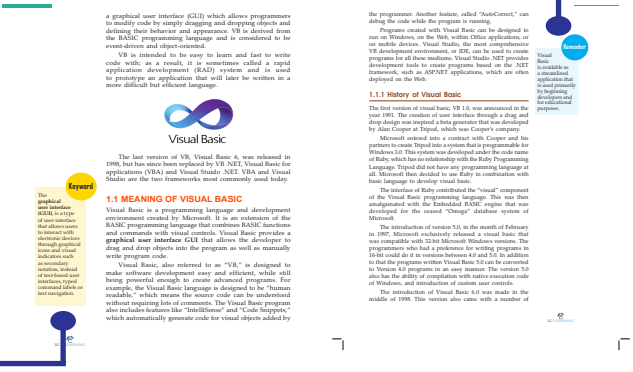
One of the most important things to be considered with regard to programming in Visual basic is that the structure of VB is designed in a way that allows programmers to create executable code – Exe files. It enables programmers to develop programs that can be used as front end to databases. Besides, it's with the help of visual basic tools, one can change the abstract ideas into programs or into the whole software while it allows revising and modifying the programs fittingly.

REMEMBER

This revitalizes a must read information of the topic.

KEYWORDS

This section contains some important definitions that are discussed in the chapter. A keyword is an index entry that identifies a specific record or document. It also gives the extra information to the reader and an easy way to remember the word definition.



a graphical user interface (GUI) which allows programmers to modify code by simply dragging and dropping objects and defining their behavior and appearance. VB is derived from the BASIC programming language and is considered to be event-driven and object-oriented.

VB is intended to be easy to learn and fast to write code with; as a result, it is sometimes called a rapid application development (RAD) system and is used to prototype an application that will later be written in a more difficult but efficient language.

Visual Basic

The last version of VB, Visual Basic 6, was released in 1998, but has since been replaced by VB .NET, Visual Basic for applications (VBA) and Visual Studio .NET. VBA and Visual Studio are the two frameworks most commonly used today.

Keyword

The graphical user interface (GUI) is a type of user interface that allows users to interact with electronic devices through graphical icons and visual indicators such as secondary notation, as opposed to most based user interfaces, typed command labels or text navigation.

1.1 MEANING OF VISUAL BASIC

Visual Basic is a programming language and development environment created by Microsoft. It is an extension of the BASIC programming language that combines BASIC functions and commands with visual controls. Visual Basic provides a **graphical user interface GUI** that allows the developer to drag and drop objects into the program as well as manually write program code.

Visual Basic, also referred to as "VB," is designed to make software development easy and efficient, while still being powerful enough to create advanced programs. For example, the Visual Basic language is designed to be "human readable," which means the source code can be understood without requiring lots of comments. The Visual Basic program also includes features like "IntelliSense" and "Code Snippets," which automatically generate code for visual objects added by

the programmer. Another feature, called "AutoCorrect," can debug the code while the program is running.

Programs created with Visual Basic can be designed to run on Windows, on the Web, within Office applications, or on mobile devices. Visual Studio, the most comprehensive VB development environment, or IDE, can be used to create programs for all these mediums. Visual Studio .NET provides development tools to create programs based on the .NET framework, such as ASP.NET applications, which are often deployed on the Web.

Remember

Visual Basic is available as a standalone application that is used primarily by beginning developers and for educational purposes.

1.1.1 History of Visual Basic

The first version of visual basic, VB 1.0, was announced in the year 1991. The creation of user interface through a drag and drop design was inspired a beta generator that was developed by Alan Cooper at Tripod, which was Cooper's company.

Microsoft entered into a contract with Cooper and his partners to create Tripod into a system that is programmable for Windows 3.0. This system was developed under the code name of Ruby, which has no relationship with the Ruby Programming Language. Tripod did not have any programming language at all. Microsoft then decided to use Ruby in combination with basic language to develop visual basic.

The interface of Ruby contributed the "visual" component of the Visual Basic programming language. This was then amalgamated with the Embedded BASIC engine that was developed for the ceased "Omega" database system of Microsoft.

The introduction of version 5.0, in the month of February in 1997, Microsoft exclusively released a visual basic that was compatible with 32-bit Microsoft Windows versions. The programmers who had a preference for writing programs in 16-bit could do it in versions between 4.0 and 5.0. In addition to that the programs written Visual Basic 5.0 can be converted to Version 4.0 programs in an easy manner. The version 5.0 also has the ability of compilation with native execution code of Windows, and introduction of custom user controls.

The introduction of Visual Basic 6.0 was made in the middle of 1998. This version also came with a number of